MAKHANA SNACK LAUNCH

A launch plan that earns the right to scale

Delhi NCR | 12-week pilot | taste, price, repeat and contribution gates

I rebuilt an early college model around evidence and stop rules.

Keshav Kapoor | 2026



Fund the pilot, not the national launch

₹30 lakh

maximum staged commitment

Prove taste and willingness to pay before quick commerce. Enter 40 to 60 NCR nodes only after those gates pass.

2 flavours

Chatpata Masala + Cream & Onion

2 packs

20 g at ₹50 + 50 g at ₹149

4 gates

taste, price, repeat, CM2

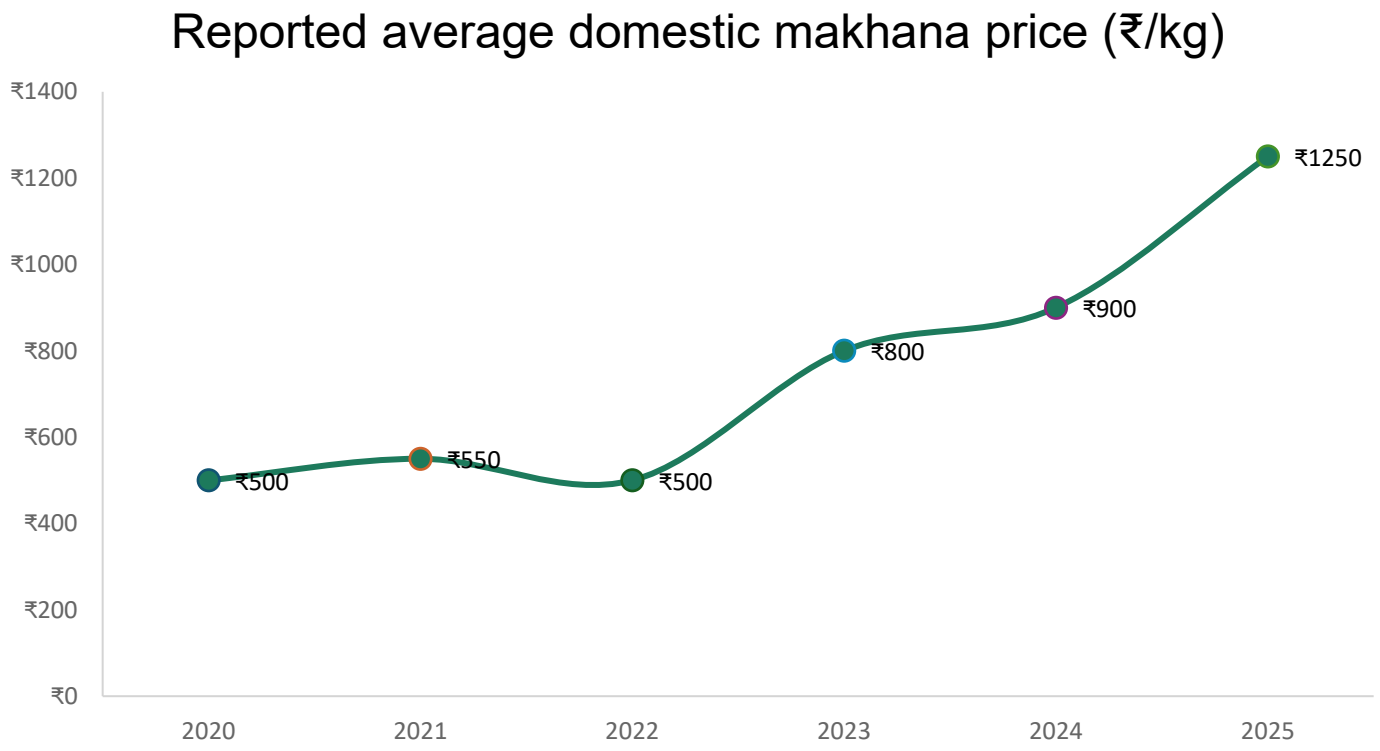
Commercial terms and thresholds are planning assumptions until replaced with actual evidence.

The first version had ambition but skipped proof

OLD MODEL	REBUILT MODEL
1,000 stores by calendar	40-60 nodes after product and price gates
15 packs/store/day assumed	Velocity learned from a controlled cell
60 g at ₹99	**20 g trial + 50 g core, both price-tested**
35% called standard	Actual terms modelled by channel and scenario
₹3.5 crore upfront	₹30 lakh in tranches with stop rules

The original appendix is preserved in the repository. Nothing has been rewritten after the fact.

The category is growing, but the input is not cheap



90%+

of global makhana supply comes from India, according to APEDA-ICRIER

Cost check

At ₹1,250/kg, 60 g of raw makhana implies ₹75 before loss, seasoning, pack, conversion or freight.

APEDA reports market averages and also notes gaps in official category data. This is context, not a supplier quote.

The shelf already has a clear trial and core ladder

TRIAL

16-20 g

₹50 MRP

Too Yumm, Farmley, Happilo

CORE

52-60 g

₹139-150 MRP

MOM, Happilo, Mr Makhana, Taali

LARGER

77-80 g

₹230-239 MRP

Farmley, Mr Makhana

Working architecture: 20 g at ₹50 for trial, 50 g at ₹149 for the core pack. Final choice follows the price test and manufacturer quotes.

MRP and observed selling prices were recorded separately on 30 August 2026 because discounts move.

Start with an occasion, not a broad age label

PRIMARY HYPOTHESIS

Late-afternoon or evening desk and streaming snack

Urban 22-35 professionals in Delhi NCR who already order snacks online.

What must be learned

01	Does it beat a familiar competitor on crunch and seasoning?
02	Will the buyer pay ₹149 without a permanent discount?
03	What snack does it replace?
04	What makes the same person buy again?

60 interviews + 120 blind tests before broad inventory

Taste first, with nutrition language that can be proved

01

Chatpata Masala

Familiar, savoury and easy to understand

02

Cream & Onion

A broad salty-snack reference point

Do not print these without proof

- high protein
- low fat
- gluten-free
- healthy

Final formula, lab result and applicable FSSAI condition decide the claim.

Each channel has one job in the pilot

TASTINGS

Find product defects

Blind score + paid conversion

20-30 STORES

Read physical discovery

Velocity + reorder + expiry

40-60 Q-COM NODES

Test convenience repeat

Full-price velocity + CM2

D2C BUNDLE

Own feedback and gifting

Bundle conversion + cohort

D2C is for bundles and learning. It is not an assumed migration away from quick commerce.

The journey ends at repeat, not at awareness

TRIGGER	EVALUATE	PAID TRIAL	CORE	REPEAT
4-8 pm snack occasion	**Taste + price**	**₹50 pack**	**₹149 pack**	**No deep discount**
Qualified reach	Blind score	Paid conversion	Trial-to-core	8-week cohort

Three recoveries worth testing

Tasted, no buy

Ask taste vs price vs pack. Change only the failed variable.

Bought once

Capture reason: flavour, texture, portion, price or no occasion.

Offer-only repeat

Read separately. It is not healthy repeat.

Out-of-stock is an operations failure. Pause paid media in affected nodes instead of blaming conversion.

The core pack works in base; the trial pack does not

BASE CORE

₹17.97

CM2 per pack

BASE TRIAL

-₹2.55

CM2 per pack

DOWNSIDE CORE

-₹8.77

CM2 per pack

What this changes

1. **Use the ₹50 pack as a measured acquisition cost, not a profit engine.**
2. **Negotiate product cost and channel deductions before locking MRP.**
3. **Do not mistake pilot GMV for a viable business.**

Base inputs: 50 g core at ₹149 MRP, 5% discount, 12% working GST, 30% channel deduction and ₹57.50 product cost.

Twelve weeks, with a decision every two

W1-2

Problem + price

60 interviews
3 price cells
3 manufacturer quotes

W3-4

Product

2 formulation rounds
120 blind tests
lab plan

W5-8

Controlled sale

pilot batch
20-30 stores
D2C bundle

W9-12

Q-commerce cell

40-60 nodes
one launch offer
cohort read

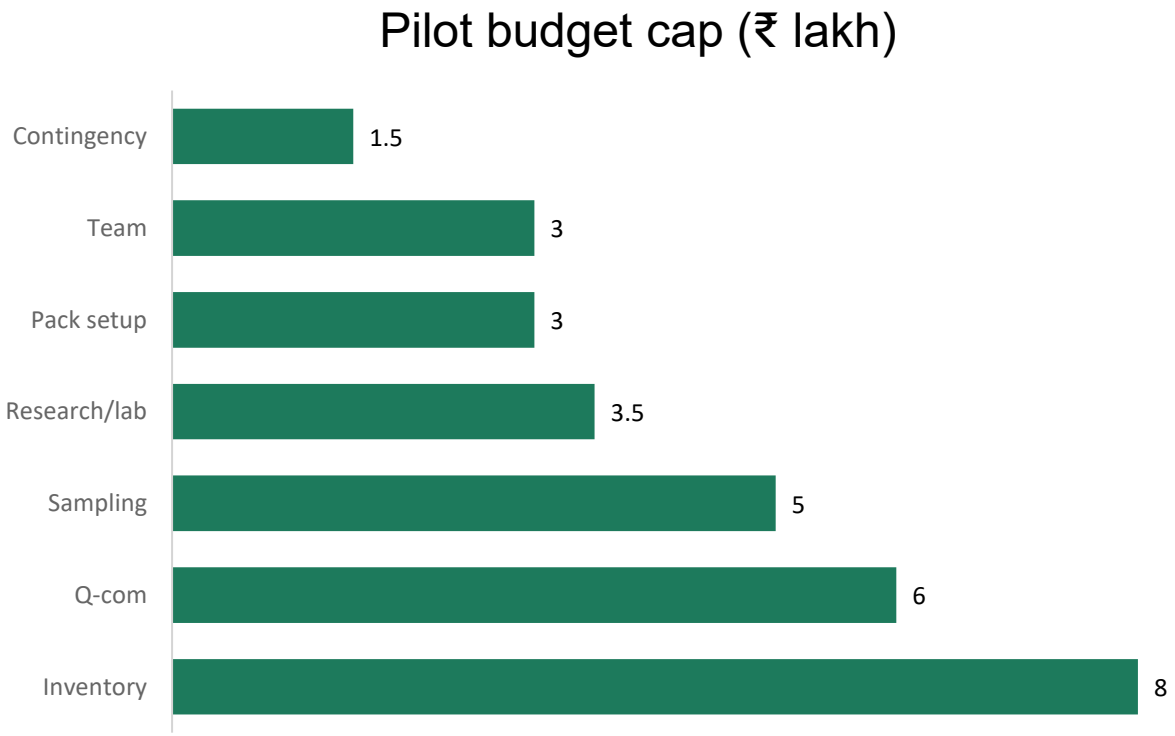
At week 12 the answer is one of four words: stop, reformulate, continue or scale.

Scale is an output of six gates

GATE	PASS RULE	IF IT FAILS
TASTE	**Parity with control**	Reformulate
PRICE	**≥35% top-two intent**	Change pack or price
VELOCITY	**Median ≥5/node/week**	Fix or remove nodes
REPEAT	**≥20% in 8 weeks**	Diagnose product/occasion
ECONOMICS	**Second-order CM2 > 0**	Renegotiate or stop
INVENTORY	**70% sold with 60% life left**	Cut next batch

Thresholds are management choices for this pilot, not industry benchmarks. Lock them before reading results.

Spend follows evidence



Three risks that can kill the plan

INPUT	Raw price moves beyond the model range
DISCOUNT	Full-price velocity disappears
EXPIRY	Stock sells too late in shelf life

The pilot can use the full ₹30 lakh only if the earlier release conditions are met.

Launch small enough to learn, but real enough to decide

1 Prove taste and price

2 Protect contribution and shelf life

3 Scale nodes only when repeat holds

Week 12

stop
reformulate
continue
scale